

Buds Air6 Pro is pretty close to that of the Oppo Enco Air3 Pro, which we consider to be the best TWS under ₹5,000. We can see anomalous peaks and dips across the frequency range when looking at the graph of the realme Buds Air6 Pro. And this is reflected in the real-world performance of the realme Buds Air6 Pro as well. Out of the box, the sound signature of the earbuds is bass-forward.

In tracks like Rescue Me by OneRepublic, you can notice that there is a significant emphasis on the bass, which tends to eat into the vocals and their clarity. However, in tracks like Selkies by BTBAM, you get a lot of detail, and the dual driver setup shines through. However, there is still residual bass, which might put off some of the purists who are looking for a flat sound signature. As for the overall staging of the sound, it is very intimate from the get-go, but with 360-degree spatial audio and other presets in the app, you can maximise the overall soundstage of these earbuds.

To get a close-to-neutral sound signature, you will have to go into the app and apply an EQ layer. You can choose from the variety of presets in the app or go for a custom curve. The six-band EQ should suffice for most people. If you are going for the presets, I would recommend the Nature Balance preset. That gave me the best results.

Now, we come to the microphone performance of the buds. It held its own in the relatively quiet office environment. The voice is clear and close to natural. However, I did notice a slight reverb added in, which I believe can be easily fixed by an OTA update.

But when faced with challenging situations, say if you are on the curbside, taking a call, then you might experience some noise seeping through, reducing the overall clarity.

As for the ANC, you can expect above-par performance from the realme Buds Air6 Pro. I wore these earbuds on a recent flight that I took. They managed to block off all the low-end



humming of the engine, and the chatter between my co-passengers was also blocked out effectively by these buds. I only experienced a few high-pitched sounds coming through, but with the buds on, I was able to get a sound sleep. You can also customise the noise cancellation levels. I generally set it to max, but you can choose to apply your own preset. I would stay away from the Smart mode though, as it tends to bring in irregularities in the level of ANC, which the buds tend to handle poorly. When in transparency mode, I did not expect any anomalous amplification of frequencies, and the sound coming through was also very close to natural. Well done, realme!

You can safely use these earbuds in the office to block out all the distractions or, during your commute, to block off all the noise around you. A word of caution, though – When walking on the streets, it is recommended that you either turn on transparency mode or use the Mild preset to stay aware of your surroundings at all times. Also, turn down the volume to around 20 per cent to stay extra safe.

BATTERY LIFE

The battery life on the realme Buds Air6 Pro, to put it simply, is satisfactory. The buds lasted almost 7 hours in my time of use, with the volume set to 50 per cent, LDAC mode on, and ANC turned on. This is just half an hour shy of the

numbers claimed by realme. So, I am happy with these numbers. Depending on your use and the number of modes that you are toggling on and off, your mileage may vary. You can maximise the battery life of the earbuds by turning ANC and high-res audio mode off and maintaining a consistent connection with your source device.

The total battery life of the buds, as per my testing, came to be around 26 hours, with some charge left in the case. When you are out of charge, you can top up the battery of the earbuds by just charging them for 10 minutes to get 7 hours of playback, as claimed by the brand.

VERDICT

realme Buds Air6 Pro emerge as a solid contender in the mid-range TWS earbuds space, potentially taking the crown of the best TWS in-ear earphones crown away from the Oppo Enco Air3 Pro. The improvement over the last-gen Buds Air5 Pro is noticeable, and for the price, you get a pair of earbuds that are solid performers in terms of features, sound signature, and battery life. The only place where I would say you tread with caution is with the aesthetics of the buds and their app. If you are not a fan of blingy design or an app which you have to sign in, to make any good use, then you should look elsewhere. Your options would be the Oppo Enco Air3 Pro and the OnePlus Buds 3, both of which are solid performers for the price.

–Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Product name: realme Buds Air6 Pro | Bluetooth version: 5.3 | Charging time: Type-C | Maximum use time (at 50% volume in AAC quality): Earbuds + charging case: 40 hours (ANC OFF) | Colors: Titanium Twilight, Silver Blue | Audio codecs: LDAC/SBC/AAC | Water resistance rating: IP55 (earbuds only) | Sound driver size: 11 mm bass driver + 6mm micro-planar tweeter | Wired charging-to-full time (charging case + earbuds): 120 mins for a full charge

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